



MULTIVERSE ROLE-PLAYING GAME

Tony's Workshop

Feedback Requested By 11/30

Tony Stark's ingenious Iron Man suit has come a long way from its original Mark I design. Each tweak gave birth to a new piece of tech for him to put to the test. As we've seen in many of his iterations, the first version isn't always the best. So, in the spirit of Tony's relentless work ethic, Tony's Workshop is a place for experimental rules and homebrew suggestions for your table. Grab some dice, give them a try, and let us know what you think at marvel.com/rpg. Who knows, some of the rules you see here may even be added to future official releases.

Verbal Combat

Many Marvel stories feature heroes and villains battling not merely with their fists but in the realm of ideas. Prime examples include the regular arguments that Mister Fantastic has with Doctor Doom, in which each tries to force the other to see things their way.

In many cases, players can simply role-play such dialogues at the table, with the Narrator and a player talking through the argument and seeing if they can come to a consensus on who has the stronger case. If there's not much on the line, this can be entertaining all by itself.

However, when the two sides are arguing over a matter of life and death—or perhaps even the fate of the world—it helps to have rules. This represents the kind of philosophical arguments that geniuses have, and determining who's in the right can have tremendous repercussions.

Verbal combat functions as a part of regular combat. It works just like the power Inspiration and many tactical powers like Battle Plan, in which the character uses words to make things happen. When engaged in it, you roll for initiative, take actions in order and so on. Such conflicts don't have to involve physical blows and can happen entirely through an exchange of ideas, but it's also possible to argue verbally while those involved trade punches too.

Verbal combat adds two new actions: Make Argument and Ignore. In addition, there are two new reactions: Mock and Bait.

Just like with existing actions, characters can use the Help action and the Help Teammate reaction to aid characters who want to Make Argument or Ignore. They just need to describe what they're doing to add to the primary character's efforts.

New Actions

Make Argument

This is a form of attack that uses Ego or Logic rather than Melee or Agility. The attack is made verbally, and the only condition is that the attacker must be able to communicate with a target who can pay attention to the attacker. Often this happens by simply speaking to a person in the same place, but it could also happen over the phone or even in text messages, sign language or any other kind of direct communication.

To make an argument, the attacker picks either Ego or Logic and makes an ability check against the target's defense score with the same ability. If the attack succeeds, it inflicts the attacker's ability damage, which is deducted from the target's Focus. On a Fantastic success, the attack does double damage.

Focus Damage Reduction—which usually comes from the Uncanny power—helps against telepathic attacks. However, it does not work against arguments.

Note that the dodge action does not work against such attacks. For a similar effect, a character can use the mock reaction or the ignore action instead.

Ignore

This functions like a dodge action, but it only works against arguments. The character uses their standard action to do this, and any arguments directed at them have trouble until the start of the character's next turn.

New Reactions

Mock

Trigger: The character is attacked with an argument. The character mocks the argument.

Effect: The attacker has trouble with the argument.

Example: *Mister Fantastic launches an argument at Doctor Doom, but Doom doesn't want to hear it. He decides to mock the argument, giving Mister Fantastic trouble on his argument check.*

Bait

Trigger: The character inflicts Focus damage on a foe with an argument. The character then uses their reaction to bait that foe.

Effect: The foe must make a Logic check against a TN equal to the damage the character did to them. If the character is the foe's Enemy (named in the Enemy tag), the foe has trouble on this check. If the foe fails the check, they cannot ignore or mock the character's arguments until the start of the character's next turn, and they must use their next standard action to attack the character with an argument if they can.

If the foe's check succeeds, they deflect the character's bait. On a Fantastic success, that character cannot try to bait them for the remainder of the battle.

Example: *Mister Fantastic hits Doctor Doom with an argument and does 31 Focus damage to him. Mister Fantastic then uses his reaction to bait Doom. The villain makes a Logic vs. TN 31 action check, and he gets a 21. Doom has failed to avoid the argument, and he is compelled to respond!*

Losing the Argument

When a combatant loses all of their Focus during an argument (i.e., falls to 0 Focus or less), they are demoralized, just like normal.

The loser must also admit that they lost the argument and cannot make any arguments of their own. If they do so, they cannot be harmed by any additional arguments until their Focus rises above 0 again. If they refuse to admit defeat, they can continue to make arguments, but they also run the risk of being argued all the way into becoming shattered.

If the loser has any henchmen who have seen them lose the argument, the winner gets an edge on any attempt to persuade or intimidate those henchmen. Conversely, if the winner has henchman of their own who see them win the argument, they gain an edge on persuading or intimidating their henchmen.

This is one reason that villains with henchmen are often willing to engage in arguments. They hope to make themselves look good in front of their henchmen, making themselves more effective leaders.

Example of Play

The Fantastic Four battle Doctor Doom. The Thing and Human Torch fight off a small army of Doombots, and the Invisible Woman protects herself and Mister Fantastic with a force-field.

While protected, Mister Fantastic tries to convince Doom that he's making a horrible mistake. He launches an argument. He uses his Logic of +7 and rolls d616. His total is (3 **6** 2 =11+7=) 18. This beats Doom's Logic Defense of 16, and the attack does ((6×8)+7=) 55 points of Focus damage to Doom, reducing his Focus to 65.

Doom uses his reaction to mock Richards, giving the argument trouble. Richards rerolls his 6 and gets a 4 instead, for a new total of 16. This still hits Doom, but it causes the Focus damage to fall to (4×8=32+7=) 39, leaving Doom with 81 Focus instead.

Richards decides to use his own reaction to bait Doom. Doom rolls d616 and gets (6 **5** 3 = 14+7=21). This is well short of the 39 he needs, so he fails the check. (With such a high TN, the Narrator could rule that it's impossible for Doom to make this and just skip the check instead.)

On his turn, Doom must make an argument against Richards. He decides to use Ego instead of Logic and rolls and gets (4 **5** 6 =15+7=22). Richards' Ego Defense is only 12, so this lands solidly, causing (5×7=35+7=) 42 points of Focus damage. This reduces Richards' Focus to 18—dangerously low!

Doom might want to bait Richards into continuing the argument, but Doom already used his reaction this round.

On the Thing's turn, though, the Thing charges past the Doombots and clobbers Doom. He rolls and gets (2 **M** 5 =13+8=) 21. This beats Doom's Melee Defense of 12, scoring a hit. Accounting for Doom's -2 Health Damage Reduction from his armor, the punch does (6×6=36+8=) 44 points of Health Damage. Doubled for the Fantastic result, that totals 88 points of damage. Doom only has 2 points of Health left, and the special effect from the Clobber power knocks him prone as well!

Animal Control

Some characters in Marvel comics have the ability to not just speak with animals but to call them to their side and issue them commands. Add these new powers to the Telepathy power set to reflect that.

These powers can be used anywhere on animals of any sort, but the character should limit them in some way that fits them thematically. Squirrel Girl, for instance, can only use these kinds of powers on squirrels, whereas Namor can use them on any aquatic animal.

Using these powers requires the character to be able to communicate in some way with the animals the powers can affect. The character must be able to contact the animal audibly (by talking or whistling), telepathically (by Animal Communication) or by some other means. The animal must also be able to reach the character. Calling a dolphin while wandering through a desert, for instance, is not likely to work.

Call Animal 1

The character can call an animal to their side.

Prerequisites: None

Action: Standard

Duration: Instant

Cost: 5 Focus

Effect: The character can call a Rank 1 animal to their side. They must be able to communicate with the animal, and the animal must be able to reach them. The number of rounds it takes the animal to reach the character is up to the Narrator. If the animal reaches the character during combat, it can enter combat on the following round.

The called animals are friendly to the character and any of the character's allies. Under normal circumstances, the animals remain near the character for an hour before wandering off.

Call Animal 2

The character can beckon a larger animal to their side.

Prerequisites: Call Animal 1, Rank 2

Action: Standard

Duration: Instant

Cost: 10 Focus

Effect: The character can call a Rank 2 animal to their side or up to two Rank 1 animals.

Call Animal 3

The character can summon a strong creature to their side.

Prerequisites: Call Animal 2, Rank 3

Action: Standard

Duration: Instant

Cost: 15 Focus

Effect: The character can call a Rank 3 animal to their side or up to two Rank 2 animals or four Rank 1 animals.

Command Animal

The character can issue orders to an animal.

Prerequisites: None

Action: Standard

Duration: 1 round

Cost: 5 Focus

Effect: The character can give an order to an animal (or group of animals) that they called with Call Animal or with which they have an Animal Bond. The animal must be within earshot or have another means of communicating with the character. If the animal is the same or a higher rank than the character, the character must make an Ego check against the animal's Ego defense. On a success, the animal complies with the order. On a Fantastic success, the character gains an edge the next time they use this power against this same target.

The command must be something that can be completed in a single turn. If it involves harming someone, the character has trouble on the check. If it would cause the animal to harm itself, the character has double trouble on the check.

Creating Animals

If a player wants to be able to call a particular kind of animal, they should work with the Narrator to come up with a profile for the animal. To do so, we use rules similar to those for creating a henchman, as found in the *Spider-Verse Expansion* and the *Avengers Expansion*. We've included a few examples here.

Animals can be anywhere from Rank 1 to 3. In general, Rank 1 animals are small, Rank 2 are average and Rank 3 are big, but this can vary depending on the kind of animal it is.

Animal ability scores total up to five times their rank. It's simplest to make each score equal to their rank, except for one score (often Logic) that is 0. However, there can be exceptions.

Animals generally get one trait per rank, but you can add ones that make sense for the particular animal.

Animals generally get one power per rank, respecting any prerequisites. Choose them to fit the type of animal.

Feel free to apply any tags that fit the animal too.

New Origin

When creating an animal's profile, use the new Animal origin. This isn't listed in the abbreviated profile that animals use (similar to that of henchmen), but it gives some guidance on what kinds of tags, traits and powers you can choose from.

Note that animals don't have to have an occupation, but outsider is listed as the one most likely to fit—at least when it comes to fitting in with human society.

The character is an animal.

Possible Tags: Amphibious, Extreme Appearance, Hounded

Possible Occupation: Outsider

Possible Powers: Additional Limbs, Animal Communication, Brawling, Crushing Grip, Environmental Protection, Evasion, Flexible Bones 1, Flight 1, Heightened Senses 1, Hit & Run, Jump 1, Mighty 1, Slip Free, Speed Run, Speed Swim, Spider-Dodge, Sturdy 1, Vicious Attack

Note that many animals in the examples have Signature Attack: Teeth. When using their teeth, these should be considered sharp melee weapons.

A stylized illustration of a white cat with black outlines, standing on a wooden floor. The cat is looking slightly to the left with a neutral expression. Its tail is long and curved upwards. The background consists of horizontal wooden planks.

RANK
1

HEALTH
30 DR:—

FOCUS
30 DR:—

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
1 MELEE	13
1 AGILITY	13
1 RESILIENCE	11
1 VIGILANCE	11
1 EGO	11
0 LOGIC	10

The diagram illustrates the calculation of EGO and LOGIC scores for the Marvel character. It shows two rows of calculations, each with a vertical label on the left.

EGO Calculation:

- Row 1: **FEAR** (vertical label) | $\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{MARVEL} \\ \text{dMarvel} \end{array} \times 1 \right] + 1$ | **ABILITY** (vertical label)
- Row 2: **AGILITY** (vertical label) | $\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{MARVEL} \\ \text{dMarvel} \end{array} \times 1 \right] + 1$ | **ABILITY** (vertical label)

LOGIC Calculation:

- Row 1: **EGO** (vertical label) | $\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{MARVEL} \\ \text{dMarvel} \end{array} \times 1 \right] + 1$ | **ABILITY** (vertical label)
- Row 2: **LOGIC** (vertical label) | $\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{MARVEL} \\ \text{dMarvel} \end{array} \times 1 \right] + 0$ | **ABILITY** (vertical label)

◆ Heightened Senses 1

- ◆ **Signature Attack:** Teeth
- ◆ **Unusual Size:** Little

- ◆ Extreme Appearance

RANK
1

HEALTH
30 DR:—

FOCUS
30 DR:—

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
1 MELEE	12
1 AGILITY	12
1 RESILIENCE	11
1 VIGILANCE	11
1 EGO	11
0 LOGIC	10

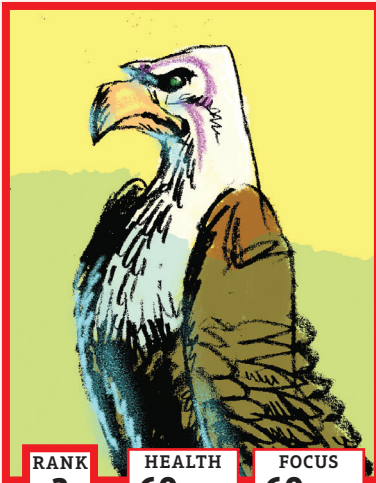
AGILITY	RELEASE	$\times 1$			$+ 1$	EGO	$\times 1$			$+ 1$
		dMarvel	MULTIPLIER		ABILITY		dMarvel	MULTIPLIER		ABILITY
AGILITY		$\times 1$			$+ 1$	LOGIC	$\times 1$			$+ 0$
		dMarvel	MULTIPLIER		ABILITY		dMarvel	MULTIPLIER		ABILITY

◆ Heightened Senses 1

- ◆ **Signature Attack: Teeth**
- ◆ Small

- ◆ Extreme Appearance

BALD EAGLE



RANK
2

HEALTH
60 DR:—

FOCUS
60 DR:—

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
2 MELEE	13
2 AGILITY	13
2 RESILIENCE	12
2 VIGILANCE	12
2 EGO	12
0 LOGIC	10

DAMAGE

MELEE	x 2 + 2	EGO	x 2 + 2
AGILITY	x 2 + 2	LOGIC	x 2 + 0

POWERS

- ♦ Flight 1
- ♦ Heightened Senses 1

TRAITS

- ♦ Signature Attack: Teeth
- ♦ Small

TAGS

- ♦ Extreme Appearance

ANIMALS

TIGER



RANK
2

HEALTH
60 DR:—

FOCUS
60 DR:—

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
2 MELEE	12
2 AGILITY	12
2 RESILIENCE	12
2 VIGILANCE	12
2 EGO	12
0 LOGIC	10

DAMAGE

MELEE	x 2 + 2	EGO	x 2 + 2
AGILITY	x 2 + 2	LOGIC	x 2 + 0

POWERS

- ♦ Heightened Senses 1
- ♦ Hit & Run

TRAITS

- ♦ Signature Attack: Teeth

TAGS

- ♦ Extreme Appearance

ANIMALS

GRIZZLY BEAR



RANK
3

HEALTH
60 DR:—

FOCUS
60 DR:—

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
3 MELEE	11
3 AGILITY	11
3 RESILIENCE	12
3 VIGILANCE	12
3 EGO	12
0 LOGIC	10

DAMAGE

MELEE	x 4 + 3	EGO	x 3 + 3
AGILITY	x 3 + 3	LOGIC	x 3 + 0

POWERS

- ♦ Crushing Grip
- ♦ Heightened Senses 1
- ♦ Mighty 1

TRAITS

- ♦ Big
- ♦ Signature Attack: Teeth

TAGS

- ♦ Extreme Appearance

ANIMALS

GREAT WHITE SHARK



RANK
3

HEALTH
60 DR:—

FOCUS
60 DR:—

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
3 MELEE	11
3 AGILITY	11
3 RESILIENCE	12
3 VIGILANCE	12
3 EGO	12
0 LOGIC	10

DAMAGE

MELEE	4 + 3	EGO	3 + 3
AGILITY	3 + 3	LOGIC	3 + 0

POWERS

- ♦ Environmental Protection
- ♦ Heightened Senses 1
- ♦ Mighty 1

TRAITS

- ♦ Big
- ♦ Breathe Different
- ♦ **Signature Attack:** Teeth

TAGS

- ♦ Extreme Appearance

ANIMALS

Zombies

Here are some rules for the kinds of zombies that are featured in the *Marvel Zombies* comics. Such zombies are created and driven by an especially vicious virus that not only kills the victim but then reanimates them as an undead creature that hungers for living flesh.

The Hunger Virus

[Based on the infection rules in the *X-Men Expansion*.]

To infect someone with the Hunger, a zombie must bite or scratch a living, sentient target and do at least 1 point of damage.

Once infected, the target must immediately make a Resilience check (which does not cost an action) against a TN of 25.

A Fantastic success on resisting an infection gives the target immunity to that disease for a full day. A regular success only provides protection against that single bite.

The virus incubates almost instantly. Each round, it does dMarvel Health×3 damage to the victim, ignoring any Health damage reduction. Eventually, this overcomes even people with the Healing Factor power.

Similarly, healing powers can be used to stave off the effects of the virus for a while. They cannot, however, cure it. The Cure-All power does not affect it at all. The Resurrect power could bring a zombie back to life but only temporarily, as it does not remove the virus.

Once the victim dies from the Hunger, the virus transforms the victim into a zombie that hungers for living flesh, preferably that of a sentient being. Their Health returns to full, and they become immune to most Health damage. However, any damage that is done to them by a Fantastic result is permanent, representing a catastrophic injury of some sort. When they reach 0 Health, they do not fall unconscious. Instead, they become immobilized—unable to physically move without some kind of assistance. If they are killed, they die permanently.

For each hour that the zombie goes without eating living flesh, the zombie must make an Ego attack roll against themselves, ignoring any Focus damage reduction. When the zombie's Focus is reduced to 0, they must then make a TN 27 Vigilance roll or go mad with hunger.

A zombie that goes mad with hunger must do anything it can to find and consume living flesh—ideally human. Once they do so, they bring their Focus back up to full, they regain control of themselves and the cycle starts all over again.

A character that becomes a zombie retains all of their powers except for Healing Factor. Any zombie that has the Beguiling trait loses it, and all zombies gain the Monster, Bloodthirsty, Fearless and Signature Attack: Teeth traits. They also gain the Extreme Appearance tag, and if they have the Heroic tag, they lose it.

There is no known cure for the disease, neither scientific nor magical. However, if a character can be kept from feeding on what they desire for about two weeks, the cravings that the Hunger induces disappear, along with the Bloodthirsty trait. This leaves the character undead but in no danger of losing their mind to the disease once again—unless they somehow indulge in their horrible fixation once more.

ZOMBIE (HENCHMAN)



RANK
1

HEALTH
30 DR:—

FOCUS
30 DR:—

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE

DEFENSE SCORE

1

MELEE

11

1

AGILITY

11

1

RESILIENCE

11

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VIGILANCE

11

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EGO

11

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LOGIC

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DAMAGE

AGILITY

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Dreamtime represents the collective unconscious of every sentient species in the entire universe. Each such species has their own version of Dreamtime, and the one for humanity is known as the Dream Dimension, which is ruled by Nightmare. Technically, a character with Omniversal Travel (Dimensional) powers can reach these Dreamtime dimensions as well, but they cannot enter the dreams of individuals without using the Enter Dreams or Enter Dreams Together powers.

Dreamtime is also a nexus of myth and legends. Using these powers, a character can also travel from Dreamtime to any realm where gods live, including Asgard, Olympus and so on. If a dreamer awakens while characters are inside of their dream, the visitors are instantly shoved back to wherever they last came from. This is usually either Dreamtime or the real world.

To take direct action in a dream they are visiting, a character must spend 5 Focus as a reaction. This allows them to take regular actions inside the dream for one round. They can even use powers that require Focus.

Focus spent or lost inside a dream is actually lost. Health lost inside a dream, though, is restored the moment the character leaves the dream.

If a character dies in a dream, they are not actually killed. Instead, they are shattered. When this happens, they should make a Challenging Ego check. On a success, they wake up shattered. On a Fantastic success, they awaken with 1 Focus. Otherwise, they are stuck in a coma until they recover from being shattered.

Powers List

- ☐ Enter Dreams
- ☐ Enter Dreams Together
- ☐ Enter Dreamtime
- ☐ Enter Dreamtime Together

Enter Dreams

The character can enter another person's dream.

Power Set: Omniversal Travel

Prerequisites: Enter Dreamtime, Rank 3

Action: Standard or movement

Duration: Instant

Cost: 10 Focus

Effect: The character instantly moves either into or out of another person's dream. To do so, the dreamer must be asleep. The character has no direct control over the dream, but they can observe it and speak with people inside it, including the dreamer.

Enter Dreams Together

The character can bring others with them into a person's dream.

Power Set: Omniversal Travel

Prerequisites: Enter Dreams, Rank 4

Action: Standard, movement or reaction

Duration: Instant

Cost: 15 Focus

Effect: The character moves into another person's dream, taking any person they are touching with them. If the target does not wish to come along, the character must grab them first. The visitors to the dream have no direct control over the dream, but they can observe it and speak with people inside it, including the dreamer.

Enter Dreamtime

The character can enter the realm of dreams.

Power Set: Omniversal Travel

Prerequisites: Rank 2

Action: Standard or movement

Duration: Instant

Cost: 15 Focus

Effect: The character instantly moves either into or out of Dreamtime. While there, they can observe the dreams of anyone who is asleep at the time. However, they cannot enter any individual's dream. When they leave Dreamtime for the real world, they return to the place where they began their journey.

Enter Dreamtime Together

The character can bring others with them into Dreamtime.

Power Set: Omniversal Travel

Prerequisites: Enter Dreamtime, Rank 3

Action: Standard, movement or reaction

Duration: Instant

Cost: 10 Focus

Effect: The character instantly moves either into or out of Dreamtime, taking any person they are touching with them. If the target does not wish to come along, the character must grab them first. While there, they can observe the dreams of anyone who is asleep at the time. However, they cannot enter any individual's dream. When they leave Dreamtime for the real world, they return to the place where they began their journey.